MWD COMPETITORS

# Method vs. Zoho

## ZOHO POSITIONING

A comprehensive, cloud-based customer relationship management solution that helps businesses manage sales, marketing, and customer support operations.

In its broader ecosystem, it seamlessly integrates with tools like Zoho Creator, a low-code platform that empowers manufacturing businesses to build and deploy custom ERP solutions.

## method POSITIONING

Method is **purpose-built for QuickBooks users** and gives businesses the power to customize workflows, manage orders and automate end-to-end sales processes, without the cost or complexity of enterprise software.

- **Flexibility and customization**
- **Two-way QuickBooks sync**
- **Lower cost than ERP softwares**

| Strengths | How to respond |
|---|---|
| **Zoho One** *(50+ tools incl. HR, inventory, CRM, finance, project mngt. under one license)* | Zoho has range but it comes with the cost of depth.<br><br>Method is purpose-built to go deeper on customer order and sales workflows, with QuickBooks integration and custom workflows. |
| **Advanced inventory features** *(multi-warehouse tracking, barcode scanning, reorder automation via Zoho Inventory)* | Zoho Inventory offers retail-style inventory depth, but you'll still need Zoho Creator to make it fit a manufacturing sales workflow.<br><br>Method has a CRM-first experience with inventory visibility where it matters, at the quote, order, and fulfillment stages. |
| **Low-code flexibility** *(Zoho Creator)* | Yes, Zoho Creator is flexible, but only if you have internal dev resources.<br><br>*Zoho customer review: "For beginners, the advance features of this tool required more time to understand."*<br><br>Method builds and maintains your customizations with you, so your team doesn't need to manage custom code |

## method

Differentiator

**"#1 QuickBooks sync in the market" -** Real-time, two-way sync with QB Desktop & Online. Allows your team to stay on the QuickBooks system they already know.

**"Enterprise customization at SMB prices" -** Method gives you the flexibility to tailor your CRM to your exact workflows, get tools you'll actually use and customization options **without the high costs or complexity of an ERP**.

**"Flexible pricing options"** based on the features (packs and apps) you'll use with DEP customization options.

For **advanced needs, Dedicated Enhancement Plans (DEP)** let you customize affordably.

| QuickBooks Desktop | QuickBooks Online |
|---|---|
| *(no native integration)* | *(native *one-way sync i.e. from Zoho to QuickBooks)* |
| Zoho does not have native QBDT integration. It **requires third-party connectors** or custom dev solutions. | **Zoho Creator:** for custom applications<br>**Zoho Flow:** to automate workflows and integrate other Zoho apps with QBO<br><br>**two-way sync possible only with additional configurations and tools* |

**Best fit customer**

Businesses with **in-house IT resources** that need an **all-in-one suite to manage everything** and for whom integration is not critical.

**Best fit customer**

Businesses **using QuickBooks that need a customizable CRM at an affordable cost** to manage sales, orders, & customers without leaving the accounting system they trust.

## What Customers Say method

*"**High implementation cost** - Sometimes high costs makes it overwhelming for small Customers. **Integration** with other tools is **limited**." -Zoho customer*

*"Zoho offers a more intuitive, user-friendly, and **cost-friendly solution** compared to Method. " -Ex-Method customer*
*(Response: Correct but only at the base plan. If you're looking for all the **features and integrations a Manufacturer requires**, Method is cheaper.*

*"They do not use the usual sales terminology and are **confusing when it comes to setting up a workflow** that works well. " -Zoho customer*

*"Limited flexibility **forced us to adapt our processes to fit its rigid structure.** Customization options are essential" -Zoho customer*

| Features | Method | Zoho |
|---|---|---|
| QuickBooks integration | Real-time, two-way sync for QBO and QBDT | QBO via Zoho Flow; no native QBDT support (3rd party only) |
| Inventory management | Basic, can be customized | Advanced via Zoho Inventory |
| Customer portal | FREE (included with subscription) | $125/month (limited to 250 users) |
| Customization DIY | N/A | $31+/month (for Zoho Creator; requires internal dev) |
| Customization support | $155/hour (DEP @ $325/for 3 hrs/month) | $160/hour (minimum 10 hours i.e. $16k) |
| Additional support and training | Dedicated support team | Varies by product (separate support plans by app) |
| Mobile access | ✓ | ✓ |
| | **$25 per user** per month | **~$168 per user** (per month incl. CRM $40, Inventory $79, Creator $25, Flow $24) |